

Blackhawk Museum Danville · 6:00–10:00pm (4 hrs) \$60,038 \$300.19 per guest, all-in	The Club at Ruby Hill Pleasanton · 6:00–11:00pm (5 hrs) \$44,021 \$220.10 per guest, all-in	Difference Ruby Hill is lower by \$16,018 \$80.09 per guest
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Where the \$80 per guest goes

Per Guest — Including Service Charge & Sales Tax	Blackhawk	Ruby Hill	What Accounts for It
Room rental	\$37.50	\$34.18	\$7,500 vs \$5,000 — but Blackhawk's carries no service charge or tax, so the real gap is \$665
Reception food	\$28.31	\$32.81	Blackhawk is lower here, on a smaller quantity
Dinner	\$122.81	\$95.70	Ruby Hill's flat rate includes dessert; Blackhawk's does not
Bar	\$95.43	\$57.42	Not like-for-like — beer & wine 4 hrs vs premium full bar 3 hrs
Linens, napkins, bar setup	\$10.28	included	Bundled into Ruby Hill's rental, along with china and silverware
Security	\$5.87	not quoted	Blackhawk's \$800 fee is billed at its 250–350 guest tier
Total per guest	\$300.19	\$220.10	Neither figure includes audio visual

The food, side by side

Blackhawk Museum Cocktail Reception · 1 hour \$28.31 / guest Three passed items — bruschetta with vine-ripened tomato & basil; coconut fried prawns with orange cocktail sauce; mini brie en croûte with spiced cranberry compote. 700 pieces total, 3.5 per guest. Cheese & fruit platters — artisanal cheeses, fruit, nuts and breads. Priced per 50 people; two on the order. Plated Dinner · Four entrée choices \$122.81 / guest Each entrée is priced separately , so the total moves with what guests order: Filet Mignon, Marchand de Vin \$85 Salmon à la Fina, lemongrass butter \$59 Chicken a La Avey, wild mushroom & fontina \$56 Rocco's Vegetarian Tower (vegan on request) \$33 Included: bread & butter, house salad, coffee & tea, printed menu cards. Not included: mini dessert bar, \$15 per guest — \$3,000.	The Club at Ruby Hill Cocktail Reception · Patio \$32.81 / guest Choose 3 from 20 items, passed or displayed, across four categories — coconut shrimp, seared ahi tuna, herbed crab cakes, bacon-wrapped scallops, chicken satay, Niman Ranch steak crostini, fig & brie crostini, arancini and more. \$24 per guest for three; \$30 for four. Plated Dinner · Six entrée choices \$95.70 / guest One flat \$70 whichever entrée a guest picks — only filet carries an upgrade: 48-Hour Beef Short Rib \$70 Walnut Crusted Halibut \$70 Chicken Ballantine \$70 Mushroom Napoleon / Baked Ziti Ricotta \$70 Filet Mignon \$82.50 Included in the \$70: choice of salad, choice of starch, choice of seasonal vegetable, choice of dessert, fresh baked rolls & butter, Starbucks coffee and Teavana iced tea.
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Same plate at both venues. A guest eating filet mignon with dessert costs **\$146.81** at Blackhawk against **\$112.79** at Ruby Hill — a **\$34.03** per-guest difference for a comparable meal.

What stands out

The service charge is the single biggest driver
Blackhawk applies 35%, Ruby Hill 24%. At Ruby Hill's rate, Blackhawk's total would fall by **\$4,281**. The lower Danville sales tax (8.75% vs 10.25%) offsets only a small part of it. 35% sits above the 20–25% market norm — worth asking whether it is negotiable.

Dessert is included at Ruby Hill and extra at Blackhawk
Ruby Hill's \$70 covers salad, starch, vegetable, dessert and coffee. Blackhawk includes salad, bread, coffee and menu cards, but the dessert bar is **\$15 per guest — \$3,000** on top. That is most of the \$27 gap on the dinner line.

Two quantities to confirm at Blackhawk
The cheese platters are priced *per 50 people* and two are on the order — coverage for 100 of 200 guests. Two more is about **\$880** all-in. Passed appetizers run 3.5 pieces per guest, where 4–6 is standard for a full cocktail hour.

Blackhawk's food bill will move — Ruby Hill's won't
Blackhawk prices each entrée separately from \$33 to \$85, so the final number depends on what guests choose. The quote assumes 90 filet / 50 salmon / 50 chicken / 10 vegetarian; a filet-heavy room would add roughly **\$4,800**. Ruby Hill stays at \$70 regardless — the dinner cost is fixed the day you sign.

The champagne greet is Blackhawk's, and it's free
200 glasses passed on arrival at **no charge** — comparable greets are usually billed at \$8–12 per guest. Ruby Hill pours house champagne at the bar in every package but offers no passed greet. Worth asking Eve for one: the champagne is already in the package, so it should cost little.

The bars aren't comparable, and neither total includes A/V
Blackhawk's beer & wine covers all four hours; Ruby Hill's premium bar covers three of its five and needs about **\$7,655** more for full coverage — still leaving it roughly **\$9,800** cheaper. Budget \$2,000–6,000 for A/V either way; Blackhawk requires you to use its provider (OAVS) directly. Ruby Hill's quote expires 29 August.

From Blackhawk event order #443-1 and Ruby Hill quote 63835076751; both totals verified line by line. Per-guest amounts apply each venue's service charge and sales tax. Correction, bar-extension and A/V estimates are CTC modeling, not venue-quoted pricing.